Coaching Codex

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COACHING CODEX · GUIDE 08 · AI FOR SALES EMAILS

# AI Sales Emails That Get Replies

Write short, human sales emails that start conversations: 25 templates for intros, follow-ups, referrals and win-backs, with AI drafting and you checking every fact.

| 25 | 4 | 7 |
| --- | --- | --- |
| email templates | kinds: intro, follow-up, referral, re-engage | day outreach plan |

START HERE

# Short emails. Real conversations.

Most sales emails get ignored because they are long, generic and all about the sender. This guide helps you write short, human emails that start a conversation: one real detail about the reader, one clear offer, one easy question. AI helps you draft and trim; you supply the facts and check every line.

**FACTS** What you offer and one real detail about them ▶ **TEMPLATE** Pick one of 25 short templates ▶ **DRAFT** AI fills it in using only your facts ▶ **CHECK** Facts, length and tone, then you send

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**THE GOLDEN RULE**

Every email should contain only **facts you have confirmed**: what you actually offer, details you actually found, dates and prices from your own records. AI is good at making your words shorter and clearer; it is not a source of new claims, results or promises.




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SECTION 01 · THE RULES

# Six rules of reply-worthy emails

A sales email is not a brochure. Its only job is to get a reply. These rules are a starting point; test them against what works for your customers.

| Rule | Instead of | Try |
|---|---|---|
| **Short**: aim for under 90 words | Three paragraphs about your company | Two or three sentences |
| **About them** first | "We are a leading agency..." | "I saw your new menu online..." |
| **One** offer | A list of every service | The one thing that fits them |
| **One** easy question | "Let me know your thoughts" | "Would two ideas be useful?" |
| **Plain** words | "Synergies", "solutions" | Words you'd say out loud |
| **True** details only | Guessed facts or made-up results | What you found and can confirm |

PROMPT · CUT MY EMAIL DOWN

Here is a sales email I wrote: [PASTE YOUR EMAIL].
Rewrite it in under [NUMBER] words. Start with something about the reader, keep one offer and end with one easy yes/no question.
Use only the facts in my email. Do not add results, prices, client names or claims. If a key fact is missing, ask me before rewriting.

EXERCISE 1 · COUNT YOUR WORDS (5 MINUTES)

Open the last sales email you sent. How many words? How many sentences are about you, and how many about the reader? Write the one question it should have ended with.



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SECTION 02 · PERSONALIZE

# Personalize with public info, not guesses

One real, specific detail shows you wrote to this person, not to a list. Find it yourself in a few minutes, then give it to AI. Never ask AI to "find" facts about a prospect: it may invent them.

1. Visit their **website**, a recent **LinkedIn** post or their **Google Business Profile**.
2. Write down **one or two facts** you can see, with where you saw them.
3. Note the **one problem** your service could help with, as a question, not an assumption.
4. Give AI those facts plus your offer, and ask for a short first line.
5. Check the line against the source before you use it.

PROMPT · PERSONALIZED FIRST LINE

I am writing a short sales email to [ROLE] at [COMPANY].
Facts I found myself (with source): [FACT 1 + WHERE I SAW IT]; [FACT 2 + WHERE].
What I offer: [YOUR SERVICE IN ONE LINE].
Write 3 options for a first line, under 20 words each, that mention one of these facts naturally. Use only these facts. Do not guess their problems, results or numbers. If something is unclear, ask me.

PRIVACY AND EMAIL RULES

Use only business information people have made public, and never paste private customer data or personal details into an AI tool. Rules on unsolicited sales email differ by country: in the US, the CAN-SPAM Act sets requirements for commercial email; in the UK and EU, rules such as PECR and GDPR can limit emails to individuals. Always include who you are and an easy way to opt out, and stop when someone asks. This is general information, not legal advice.



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SECTION 03 · INTRO EMAILS

# Intro templates: the first email (1–7)

Use these for someone who has never heard from you. Fill every bracket with a confirmed fact, or delete the line. Keep the finished email under about 90 words.

1. **Public detail**: Hi [NAME], I saw [SPECIFIC DETAIL + WHERE]. I help [WHO] with [ONE THING YOU DO]. Would it be useful if I sent [ONE SMALL IDEA]?

2. **Quick question**: Hi [NAME], how does [COMPANY] handle [TASK] today? I [WHAT YOU DO] for [SIMILAR BUSINESSES]. Worth a 15-minute call?

3. **Their news**: Congrats on [PUBLIC NEWS]. When a business [CHANGE], [TASK] can get harder. I help with exactly that. Open to two ideas?

4. **Mutual contact**: [CONTACT] suggested I get in touch about [TOPIC]. I [WHAT YOU DO]. Would a short call next week work?

5. **Local**: I work with [TYPE OF BUSINESS] in [CITY] on [SERVICE]. I noticed [DETAIL]. Would a quick idea for that be helpful?

6. **Free resource**: I made a one-page [CHECKLIST/GUIDE] for [WHO] about [TOPIC]. Want me to send it over? No strings.

7. **Right person**: Are you the right person to talk to about [TOPIC] at [COMPANY]? If not, who would be?

PROMPT · FILL AN INTRO TEMPLATE

Fill in this email template: [PASTE TEMPLATE].
About me: [YOUR BUSINESS + ONE-LINE OFFER]. About them: [CONFIRMED FACTS + SOURCE]. Language: [LANGUAGE].
Keep it under 90 words and end with one yes/no question. Use only these facts. If a bracket can't be filled from my facts, leave it as [MISSING] and tell me.

MAKE IT SOUND LIKE YOU

After the draft, read it out loud. Change any word you would never say to a customer in person. Short and a little plain beats polished and generic.



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SECTION 04 · FOLLOW-UPS

# Follow-up templates and timing (8–13)

Many replies come after a follow-up, not the first email. Keep each one shorter than the last, add something useful, and stop after two or three tries.

8 **Gentle check**: Just checking this reached you. [ONE-LINE RECAP]. Is [TOPIC] still on your list?

9 **One more idea**: One more thought on [TOPIC]: [SHORT IDEA]. Happy to share more if useful.

10 **After a quote**: Following up on the quote for [SERVICE] I sent on [DATE]. Any questions I can answer before you decide?

11 **After a call**: Thanks for the call on [DAY]. As agreed: [NEXT STEPS]. Does [DATE AND TIME] still work for you?

12 **Timing**: Is [TOPIC] a priority this quarter, or should I check back in [MONTH]?

13 **Close the loop**: I haven't heard back, so I'll assume now isn't the right time. If that changes, just reply here.

| Follow-up | A common gap (estimate) | Use template |
|---|---|---|
| 1st | 3–4 business days after the first email | 8 or 9 |
| 2nd | About a week after the 1st | 12 |
| Last | About two weeks after the 2nd | 13 |

**TIMING IS A STARTING POINT**

These gaps are rough estimates, not rules. Adjust to your industry and to anything the person told you, such as "I'm away until March 3."



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SECTION 05 · REFERRALS

# Referral templates: ask happy clients (14–18)

A warm introduction from a happy client is often easier than any cold email. Ask right after a good result, and make it easy to say yes or no.

14 **Simple ask**: I'm glad [RESULT YOU DELIVERED] worked out. Do you know one [TYPE OF BUSINESS] who might find [SERVICE] useful?

15 **Make it easy**: If it helps, here's a two-line note you could forward: [SHORT BLURB ABOUT YOUR SERVICE].

16 **Ask for an intro**: Would you be comfortable introducing me to [NAME] at [COMPANY]? Totally fine if not.

17 **Email the referral**: Hi [NAME], [CLIENT NAME] mentioned you're [SITUATION THEY SHARED]. I helped them with [PROJECT]. Would a short call be useful?

18 **Say thank you**: Thank you for introducing me to [NAME]. [WHAT HAPPENED NEXT, IF THEY AGREED TO SHARE]. I really appreciate it.

PROMPT · REFERRAL REQUEST

Write a short, friendly email to a client asking for a referral.
Client: [FIRST NAME]. What we did together: [CONFIRMED PROJECT AND RESULT IN THEIR WORDS OR YOURS].
Who I'd like to meet: [TYPE OF BUSINESS OR PERSON]. Language: [LANGUAGE].
Under 80 words, no pressure, easy to say no. Use only these facts and do not invent results. If something is missing, ask me.

EXERCISE 2 · THREE PEOPLE TO ASK

Write the names of three clients who were happy with your work recently, and the result you'd mention to each. Only results you can confirm.



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SECTION 06 · RE-ENGAGE

# Re-engage templates: past clients and old leads (19–25)

People who already know you are often the easiest to talk to. These templates reopen a conversation without sounding like a mass email.

19 **Check in**: It's been [TIME] since we worked on [PROJECT]. How is [AREA] going?

20 **Something new**: We now offer [NEW SERVICE]. Given [WHY IT MAY FIT THEM], would it be worth a look?

21 **Old lead**: Back in [MONTH] we talked about [TOPIC]. Is that still on your mind?

22 **Season or deadline**: With [SEASON OR DEADLINE] coming up, is [TASK] on your list this year?

23 **Useful share**: I came across [IDEA OR ARTICLE] and thought of your [PROJECT]. Here's the short version: [ONE LINE].

24 **Not now, later**: Thanks for letting me know. Mind if I check back in [MONTH]?

25 **Keep in touch**: Should I keep sending you the occasional note about [TOPIC], or would you rather I didn't? Either answer is fine.

PROMPT · RE-ENGAGE A PAST CLIENT

Write a short check-in email to a past client.
What we worked on and when: [PROJECT + MONTH/YEAR]. What's new with us, if anything: [CONFIRMED NEWS OR "NOTHING"].
Under 70 words, warm, one easy question. Use only these facts; do not mention discounts, results or offers I haven't listed. Ask me if anything is missing.

CHECK YOUR RECORDS FIRST

Before writing, look up the real project, dates and any open invoices in your own records. A wrong date or project name undoes the personal touch.



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SECTION 07 · SUBJECT LINES

# Subject lines and the final check

A good subject line usually looks like a note from a person: short, specific, lowercase-friendly and honest about what's inside.

| Pattern | Example (fictional) |
|---|---|
| **Their thing** | your new Lakewood location |
| **Question** | quick question about bookings |
| **Mutual** | Anna at Lumen suggested I write |
| **Follow-up** | re: quote for the spring menu |

PROMPT · SUBJECT LINES

Here is my finished email: [PASTE EMAIL].
Write 5 subject line options under 6 words each. Make them specific to the email, honest about what's inside, with no clickbait, all caps or fake "Re:" lines. Use only words and facts from the email.

- [ ] Every fact, date, name and price matches my records or the source I found
- [ ] No results, client names or promises were added by AI
- [ ] Under about 90 words, one offer, one question
- [ ] Says who I am and how to opt out of further emails
- [ ] I read it out loud and it sounds like me

EXERCISE 3 · BEFORE AND AFTER

Take the email from Exercise 1. Rewrite it with a template and the prompts in this guide. Write the new subject line and word count.



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SECTION 08 · HABIT

# Your 7-day outreach plan

Short daily sessions beat one big push. After the first week, keep the tracker going and review it every Friday.

| Day | Action | Time (est.) | Done |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Rewrite your old email with the six rules; pick 10 prospects | 30 min | |
| 2 | Find one public fact for each prospect, with the source | 30 min | |
| 3 | Draft and check 5 intro emails (templates 1–7); send | 30 min | |
| 4 | Draft and check the other 5 intro emails; send | 30 min | |
| 5 | Ask 2 happy clients for referrals (templates 14–18) | 20 min | |
| 6 | Send 3 re-engage emails to past clients (19–25) | 20 min | |
| 7 | Send follow-ups (8–13); log replies; plan next week | 30 min | |

Times are rough estimates and vary by business.

PROMPT · WEEKLY REVIEW

This week I sent these emails: [LIST: TEMPLATE NUMBER, TYPE, SUBJECT LINE].
What happened, from my own records: [REPLIES, NO REPLIES, MEETINGS].
Suggest what to keep and what to change next week, using only these notes. Do not guess reasons I haven't given you; ask me instead.

| Prospect (no personal data) | Template | Sent | Follow-up | Reply? |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |



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FIRST WIN · FICTIONAL EXAMPLE

# Your first win, start to finish

Walk through cutting a long, ignored sales email down to about 60 words for Northpeak Web, a made-up freelance web designer in Denver, writing to a made-up dental practice. Nothing here is a real business, person or email.

| Example input | Value |
|---|---|
| My long draft (summary) | Three paragraphs about my 8 years of experience, my design process and my full service list, ending with "Let me know your thoughts." |
| Fact I found (with source) | Maple Street Dental's website says they opened a second location in Lakewood this spring. |
| My one offer | I build simple, mobile-friendly booking pages for dental practices. |
| Tone and language | Friendly and plain, English |

**EXAMPLE COMPLETED PROMPT**

Rewrite my sales email in English, in under 60 words, to the practice manager at Maple Street Dental.

Fact I found myself: their website says they opened a second location in Lakewood this spring.
My one offer: I build simple, mobile-friendly booking pages for dental practices.
About me: Sam at Northpeak Web, a freelance web designer in Denver.

Start with the fact about them, keep only my one offer, and end with one easy yes/no question. Tone: friendly and plain. Use only these facts. Do not add results, prices, client names, years of experience or claims about their current website. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

Copy it, open your AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot), paste and send. Then compare what you get with this:

**ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT**

Subject: your new Lakewood location Hi, I saw on your website that Maple Street Dental opened a second location in Lakewood this spring. Congratulations! I build simple, mobile-friendly booking pages for dental practices. Would it be useful if I sent two ideas for the new location's page? Sam, Northpeak Web (Denver)

## Checks before use

- [ ] The Lakewood fact matches what the practice's website actually says.
- [ ] No results, prices, client names or claims about their website were added.
- [ ] It has one offer and ends with one easy yes/no question, in under 60 words.
- [ ] Before sending, you add an opt-out line and read it out loud.

**USE IT**

Copy the checked email, open your email app, paste it into a new message to the right person, add your signature and opt-out line, and send it yourself. The webpage does not send anything for you.



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GUIDED TASK

# Write a first email to a new prospect

**When to use it:** You want to contact a business that has never heard from you and get a reply, not a sale. **Prepare:** One or two facts you found about them, and where you saw each; Your one offer in a sentence; Who you are writing to (role, not personal details).

| Question | Example answer |
|---|---|
| Describe your business in one sentence. | Northpeak Web, a freelance web designer in Denver (fictional) |
| Who are you writing to? | The practice manager at Maple Street Dental (fictional) |
| What public fact did you find, and where? | Their website says they opened a second location in Lakewood this spring |
| What is your one offer for them? | Simple, mobile-friendly booking pages for dental practices |
| Which language should the email be in? | English |

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Write a short first sales email (under 80 words) with 3 subject line options.
About me: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
I am writing to: [WHO]
Fact I found myself: [FACT + SOURCE]
My one offer: [ONE OFFER]
Language: [LANGUAGE].
Start with the fact about them, keep only my one offer and end with one easy yes/no question. Plain, friendly words. Use only these facts. Do not add results, prices, client names or guesses about their problems. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Subject options: 1) your new Lakewood location 2) booking page idea 3) quick question Hi, I saw on your website that you opened a second location in Lakewood this spring. Congratulations! I build simple, mobile-friendly booking pages for dental practices. Would two ideas for the new location's page be useful? Sam, Northpeak Web

## Checks before use

- [ ] The fact about them matches the source you saw, word for word where quoted.
- [ ] No results, prices, client names or guesses were added.
- [ ] One offer, one yes/no question, under 80 words.
- [ ] You add your signature and an opt-out line before sending.

## Repairs

| If... | Send this |
|---|---|
| Added a claim or guess | "Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else." |
| Too long or salesy | "Cut this to under [NUMBER] words. Keep the fact about them, my one offer and the final question." |
| Weak ending | "Replace the last line with one easy yes/no question about [TOPIC]. Change nothing else." |

**Next action:** Paste the checked email into your email app, add your signature and opt-out line, send it yourself, and note the date in your tracker.



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GUIDED TASK

# Follow up when nobody replies

**When to use it:** You sent an email or a quote a few days ago and heard nothing back. **Prepare:** What you sent and the date, from your sent folder; Any quote reference or amount, from your own records; One useful new idea or detail, if you have one.

| Question | Example answer |
|---|---|
| Describe your business in one sentence. | Harbor Lane Bookkeeping, a small bookkeeping firm in Bristol (fictional) |
| What did you send, and on what date? | A quote (Q-114) for monthly bookkeeping, sent on March 3 |
| What was the main point, in one line? | Monthly bookkeeping and VAT returns for GBP 240 a month |
| Any useful new detail to add? | We can start in April if they decide by March 20 |
| Which language should the email be in? | English |

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Write a short, friendly follow-up email (under 60 words).
About me: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
What I sent: [WHAT + DATE]
Main point: [ONE-LINE RECAP]
Useful new detail: [NEW DETAIL]
Language: [LANGUAGE].
Keep it shorter than a first email, do not sound pushy or guilt-trip, and end with one easy question. Use only these facts and figures exactly as given. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Subject: re: quote Q-114 Hi, Just checking my quote from March 3 reached you: monthly bookkeeping and VAT returns for GBP 240 a month. If you decide by March 20, we can start in April. Any questions I can answer? Harbor Lane Bookkeeping

## Checks before use

- [ ] The quote reference, amount, currency and date match your records exactly.
- [ ] No new discount, deadline or promise was added.
- [ ] It is shorter than the first email and ends with one easy question.
- [ ] It doesn't sound pushy or guilt-tripping.

## Repairs

| If... | Send this |
|---|---|
| Wrong figure or date | “Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.” |
| Sounds pushy | “Rewrite this in a relaxed, no-pressure tone. Keep the facts and the question.” |
| Too long | “Cut this to under [NUMBER] words. Keep the reference, the date and the question.” |

**Next action:** Send the checked follow-up yourself from the same email thread, and log it in your tracker. Stop after two or three follow-ups.



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GUIDED TASK

# Ask a happy client for a referral

**When to use it:** A client is happy with a recent project and you'd like an introduction to someone similar. **Prepare:** The client's first name; The project and a result you can confirm; The type of business you'd like to meet.

| Question | Example answer |
|---|---|
| Describe your business in one sentence. | Studio Kiel, a brand design studio in Berlin (fictional) |
| What is the client's first name? | Lena |
| What did you do together, and what changed? | A new logo and menu design for her café; she told us guests now ask about the menu artwork |
| Who would you like to be introduced to? | Other independent cafés or bakeries opening soon |
| Which language should the email be in? | English |

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Write a short, friendly email asking a happy client for a referral (under 80 words).
About me: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
Client's first name: [CLIENT FIRST NAME]
What we did and the confirmed result: [PROJECT + RESULT]
Who I'd like to meet: [WHO YOU'D LIKE TO MEET]
Language: [LANGUAGE].
Thank them first, make it easy to say no, and offer a two-line blurb they could forward. Use only these facts; do not invent results or quotes. If something essential is missing, ask me before drafting.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Subject: a small favor? Hi Lena, Thank you again for trusting us with your logo and menu. It was lovely to hear that guests ask about the menu artwork. Do you know another independent café or bakery opening soon that might like a hand? Here's a note you could forward: "Studio Kiel designed our logo and menu. Worth a chat." No pressure at all. Studio Kiel

## Checks before use

- [ ] The project and result match what really happened and what the client said.
- [ ] No new results, quotes or numbers were added.
- [ ] It's easy to say no, and the forwardable blurb is accurate.
- [ ] The client's name is spelled correctly.

## Repairs

| If... | Send this |
|---|---|
| Invented result or quote | “Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.” |
| Feels like pressure | “Make this lighter and easier to decline. Keep the thanks and the blurb.” |
| Blurb too long | “Shorten the forwardable note to under [NUMBER] words, using only the confirmed facts.” |

**Next action:** Send the checked email yourself, and when you get an introduction, use templates 17 and 18 from the guide to reply and say thank you.



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WHAT'S NEXT

# Short emails. More conversations.

One real detail, one offer, one easy question, checked before you send: that's an outreach routine you can keep up every week.

**Follow-Up Without Fear: AI Scripts for Quotes, Leads & Win-Backs**

Follow up on quotes and leads without feeling pushy.

**Admin on Autopilot: Proposals, Quotes & Paperwork with AI**

Turn a good reply into a clear proposal, fast.

**Automate Your Inbox and Customer Replies with AI**

Handle the replies your emails bring in.

**50 Copy-Paste AI Prompts for Small Business Owners**

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